Home & belonging

Long for return

1 I Shall Return: the idea

Remembered home → Future promise

Present pain → Hoped-for relief

McKay's speaker promises a return to cherished landscape, music and community. Precious colours make the remembered homeland valuable.

Final pain explains the need for belonging. Repetition expresses resolve and possible self-reassurance.

2 McKay: the method

A Shakespearean sonnet: three quatrains and a couplet. Nature → community → emotional explanation.

Jamaican migration and the Harlem Renaissance illuminate cultural attachment. The hoped-for return is not shown happening.

Find inward restoration

3 Compare Wordsworth

Both connect nature with emotional relief. Wordsworth's remembered flowers already change his present mood.

McKay longs to be physically home. Compare **fulfilled recollection** with **future promise,** using each ending.

4 Compare Drummer Hodge

Both place identity in relation to a landscape. Hodge's unfamiliar sky contrasts with McKay's cherished colours and music.

Hodge cannot return. The landscape absorbs him after death; McKay imagines belonging through living participation.

Face permanent separation

5 Context changes meaning

Wordsworth: Romantic faith in imagination. McKay: separation from a homeland and culture. Hardy: an ordinary life displaced by imperial war.

Use these contexts to explain specific choices, not as detached biography.

6 Write a connected argument

Choose the pair that fits the question. Track time: remembered past → present effect → hoped-for or permanent future.

Compare language, form and structure as well as content. A shared natural setting does not prove shared emotions.